



THE KENYA CONSUMER PRICE INDEX AND INFLATION REPORT

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Overview

Annual consumer price inflation as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) was 4.3 per cent in February 2026. This implies that the general price level was 4.3 per cent higher in February 2026 than it was in February 2025. The price increase was primarily driven by a rise in prices of items in the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages (7.3%); Transport (4.0 %), and Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and other fuels (1.8%) over the one-year period. These three divisions together account for over 57 per cent of the total weight across the 13 major expenditure categories.

Consumer Price Index (CPI) is defined as a measure of the weighted aggregate change over time in retail prices paid by consumers for a given basket of goods and services. The CPI measures the cost of purchasing this fixed basket of goods and services, comparing current prices to those of a base period, which for the current CPI is February 2019. Inflation rate is defined as a percentage change of the CPI between two periods. There are different inflation rates that can be computed, such as annual (year-on-year), quarterly (quarter-to-quarter) and monthly (month-on-month) inflation rates. Data used to derive the inflation rates is collected through a monthly survey of retail prices from a statistically representative sample of outlets in urban areas across 50 data collection zones nationwide. The survey is conducted during the second and third weeks of the month.

The Overall CPI and Inflation Trends, February 2025 - February 2026

As presented in Figure 1, the overall index increased from 148.96 in January 2026 to 149.20 in February 2026, resulting to a monthly inflation rate of 0.2 per cent. The year-on-year inflation was 4.3 per cent in February 2026 as shown in Figure 2.

Figure 1: Overall CPI February 2025 – February 2026

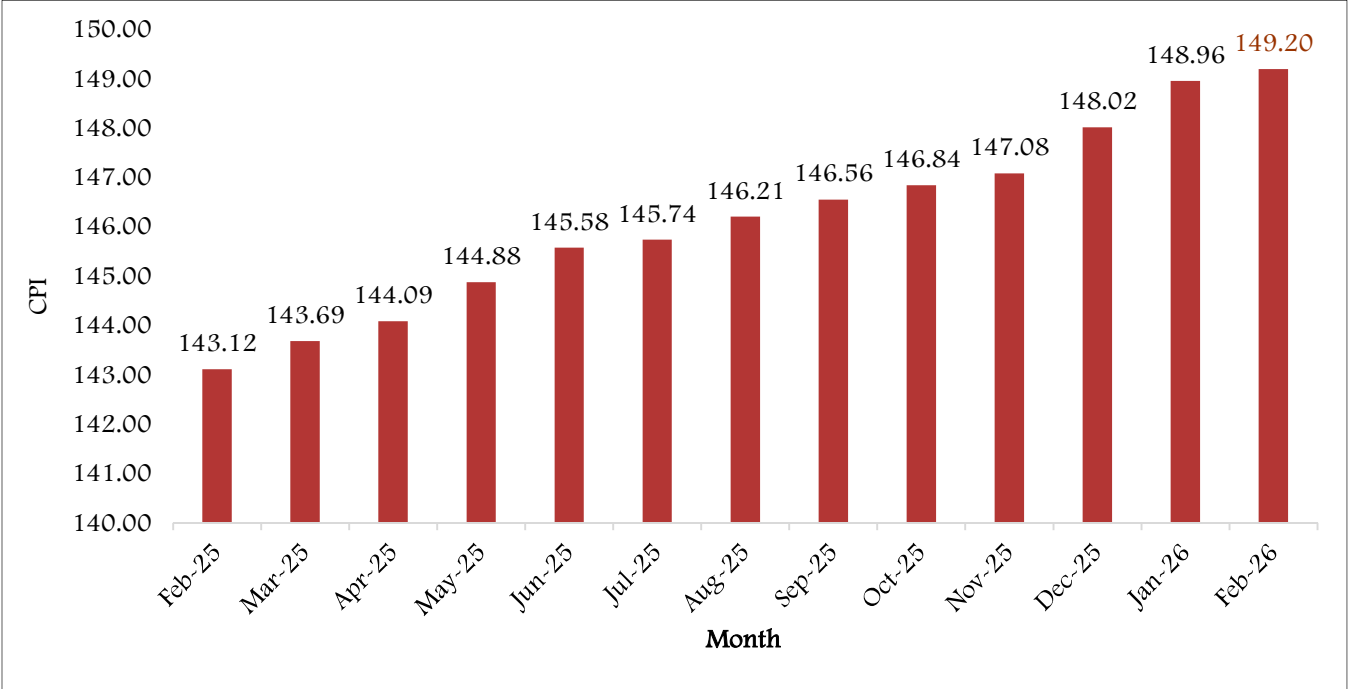


Figure 2: Inflation Trends, February 2025 – February 2026

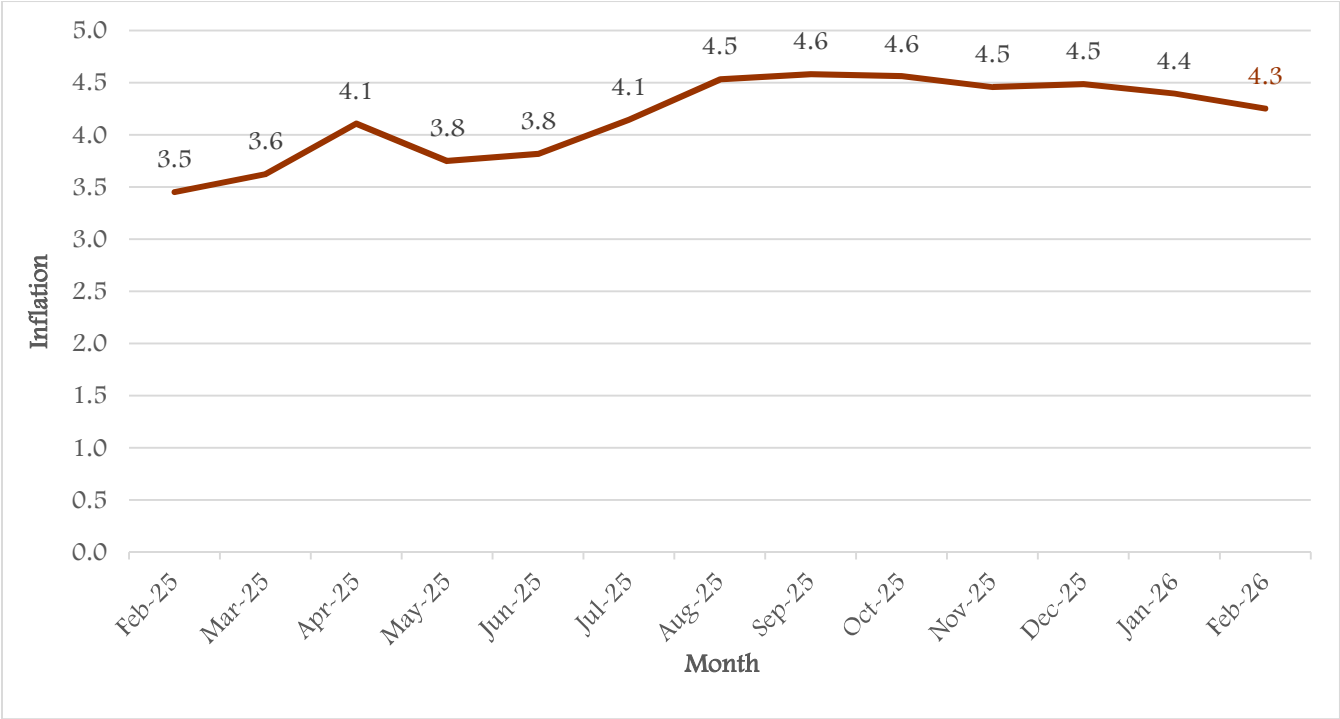


Table 1: One and Twelve-Month Percentage Changes in the Consumer Price Indices

13 COICOP Divisions	Weight %	% Change on last month (February 2026 / January 2026)	% Change on same month of the previous year (February 2026 / February 2025)
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	32.9094	0.6	7.3
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	3.3289	0.1	2.5
Clothing and Footwear	2.9914	0.1	2.0
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	14.6124	-0.4	1.8
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	3.7372	0.1	1.4
Health	2.9116	0.3	2.4
Transport	9.6468	-0.7	4.0
Information and Communication	7.7840	0.0	0.4
Recreation, Sport and Culture	1.7219	0.2	2.6
Education Services	5.5620	0.4	3.0
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	8.0991	0.5	2.7
Insurance and Financial Services	2.2423	0.1	0.7
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	4.4532	0.2	2.5
Total	100.0000	0.2	4.3

Figure 3: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, January 2026 – February 2026

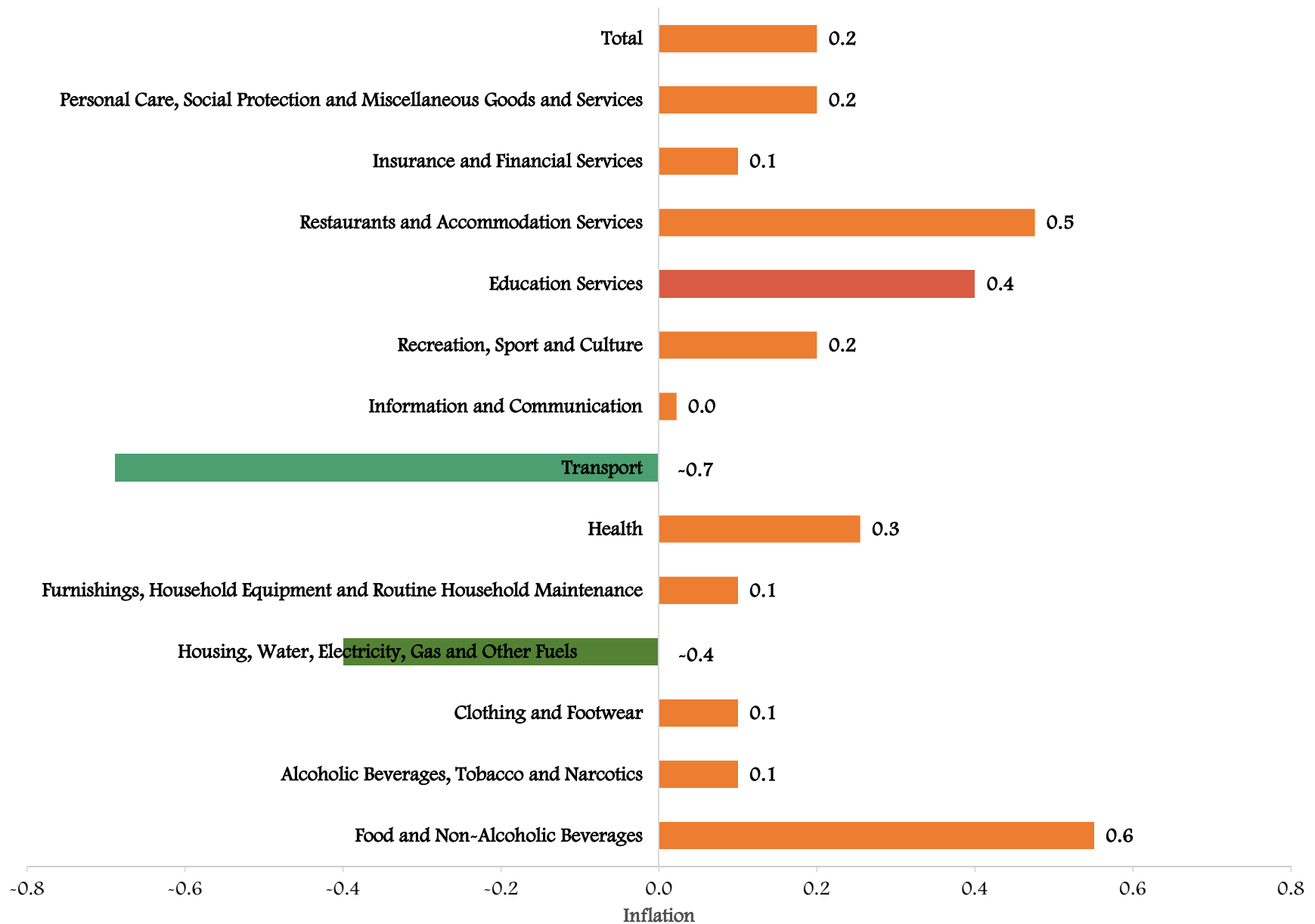


Figure 4: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, February 2025 – February 2026

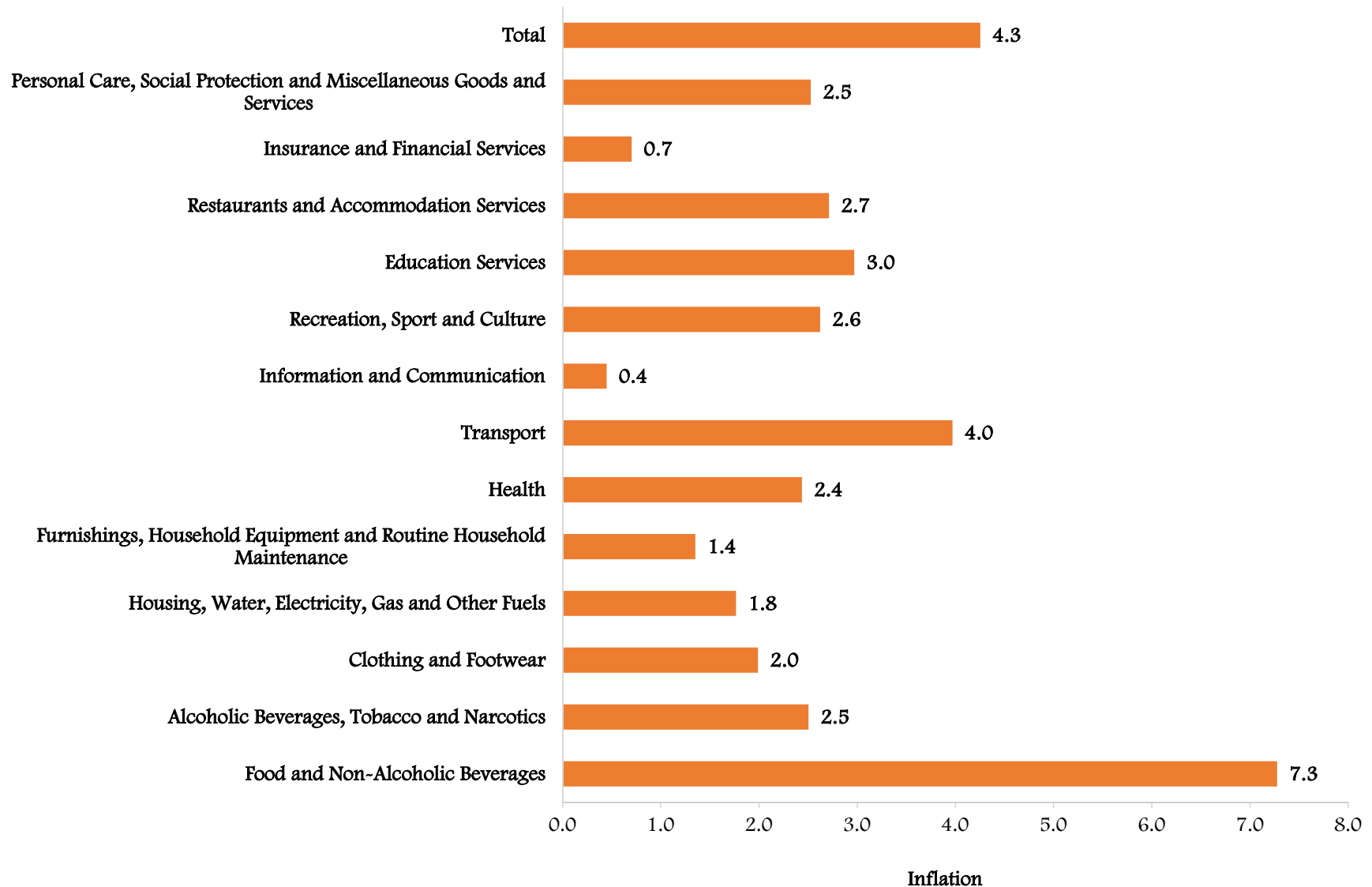


Table 2: Key Drivers of Inflation for each of the 13 Divisions

Monthly		Yearly
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages		
  0.6%	Between January 2026 and February 2026, prices of sugar, mangoes and wheat flour-white recorded a decrease in prices which went down by 4.4, 3.2 and 0.8 per cent, respectively. In the same period, prices of kale-sukumawiki went up by 2.4 per cent while prices of cabbage and potatoes increased by 4.0 per cent each.	 7.3% Over the twelve months until February 2026, the Food and Non-alcoholic Beverages division index rose by 7.3%.
Transport		
  -0.7%	During the period between January 2026 and February 2026, prices of transport-related items showed mixed trends. Price of diesel and petrol dropped by 2.3 per cent each in the review period. In addition, fares of country bus/matatu fares from one town to another went down by 1.4 per cent.	 4.0% Over the twelve months until February 2026, the index for the Transport division rose by 4.0 per cent.
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels		
  -0.4%	Electricity price decreased by 2.9 per cent and 2.7 per cent for 50 kWh and 200 kWh respectively between January 2026 and February 2026. In addition, prices of kerosene and gas/LPG decreased by 0.6 per cent 0.4 per cent, respectively, during the same period.	 1.8% Over the twelve months until February 2026, the general price levels for the division rose by 1.8 per cent.
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics		
  0.1%	Between January 2026 and February 2026, beer (lagers and stouts) recorded a slight price decline of 0.2 per cent. In contrast, miraa (khat) experienced the largest increase at 1.3 per cent while. spirits registered a price increase of 0.3 per cent.	 2.5% Over the twelve months until February 2026, the Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics index rose by 2.5%.
Clothing and Footwear		
  0.1%	Between January 2026 and February 2026, prices of clothing items showed both decreases and increases. Girls' dresses and men's suits recorded price declines of 0.6 percent and 0.4 percent, respectively. In addition, men's T-shirts showed a notable decrease of 4.1 per cent. In contrast, men's coats rose by 2.7 per cent. The cost of tailoring and clothing repairs also increased slightly by 0.9 per cent.	 2.0% Over the twelve months until February 2026, the prices under Clothing and Footwear division rose by 2.0%.
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance		
  0.1%	Detergents recorded a slight decrease of 0.1 per cent, while refrigerators and freezers declined by 2.6 per cent, indicating lower prices during the period. In contrast, dish washing paste/liquid increased by 1.6 per cent.	 1.4% Over the twelve months until February 2026, the prices under Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance division rose by 1.4%.
Health		
  0.3%	Dewormers showed a slight decrease of 0.1 per cent. In contrast, medicines for cholesterol and blood pressure increased by 0.4 per cent, while general practitioner's services rose by 0.7 per cent.	 2.4% Over the twelve months until February 2026, the Health division index rose by 2.4%.

Monthly		Yearly	
Information and Communication			
  0.0%	Between January 2026 and February 2026, prices for items under ICT remained constant.	 0.4%	The sector recorded a yearly inflation of 0.4%.
Recreation, Sport and Culture			
  0.2%	Between January 2026 and February 2026, prices of tour and honeymoon packages recorded a slight decrease of 0.1 per cent. The prices of exercise books increased by 0.5 per cent, and pre-primary and primary school textbooks rose by 0.3 per cent.	 2.6%	Over the twelve months until February 2026, the Recreation, Sport and Culture division index went up by 2.6%.
Education Services			
  0.4%	Between January 2026 and February 2026, certificate course fees recorded a slight increase of 0.1 per cent	 3.0%	Over the twelve months until February 2026, the index for the Education division increased by 3.0%.
Restaurants and Accommodation Services			
  0.5%	Between January 2026 and February 2026, prices of hotel and restaurant cakes and snacks rose by 0.8 per cent, while lodging and guest expenses increased by 0.6 per cent. Similarly, food from vendors recorded an increase of 0.8 per cent.	 2.7%	Over the twelve months until February 2026, the index for the Restaurants and Accommodation Services division rose by 2.7%.
Insurance and Financial Services			
  0.1%	Prices of medical insurance and motor vehicle insurance each rose by 0.2 per cent	 0.7%	Over the twelve months until February 2026, the prices under Insurance and Financial Services division went up by 0.7%.
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services			
  0.2%	Prices of hair dressing services rose by 0.1 per cent, while toilet soap increased by 0.9 per cent. Toilet paper/tissue paper prices recorded a higher increase of 1.4 per cent.	 2.5%	Over the twelve months until February 2026, the index for the Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services division increased by 2.5%.

Movement of National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Between January 2026 and February 2026, prices of selected food commodities showed mixed movements. The price of sugar declined from KSh 174.17 to KSh 166.56 per kilogramme, while that of a kilogramme of mangoes declined from KSh 149.09 to KSh 144.37. The price of one kilogramme of tomatoes declined from KSh 87.98 to KSh 87.90.

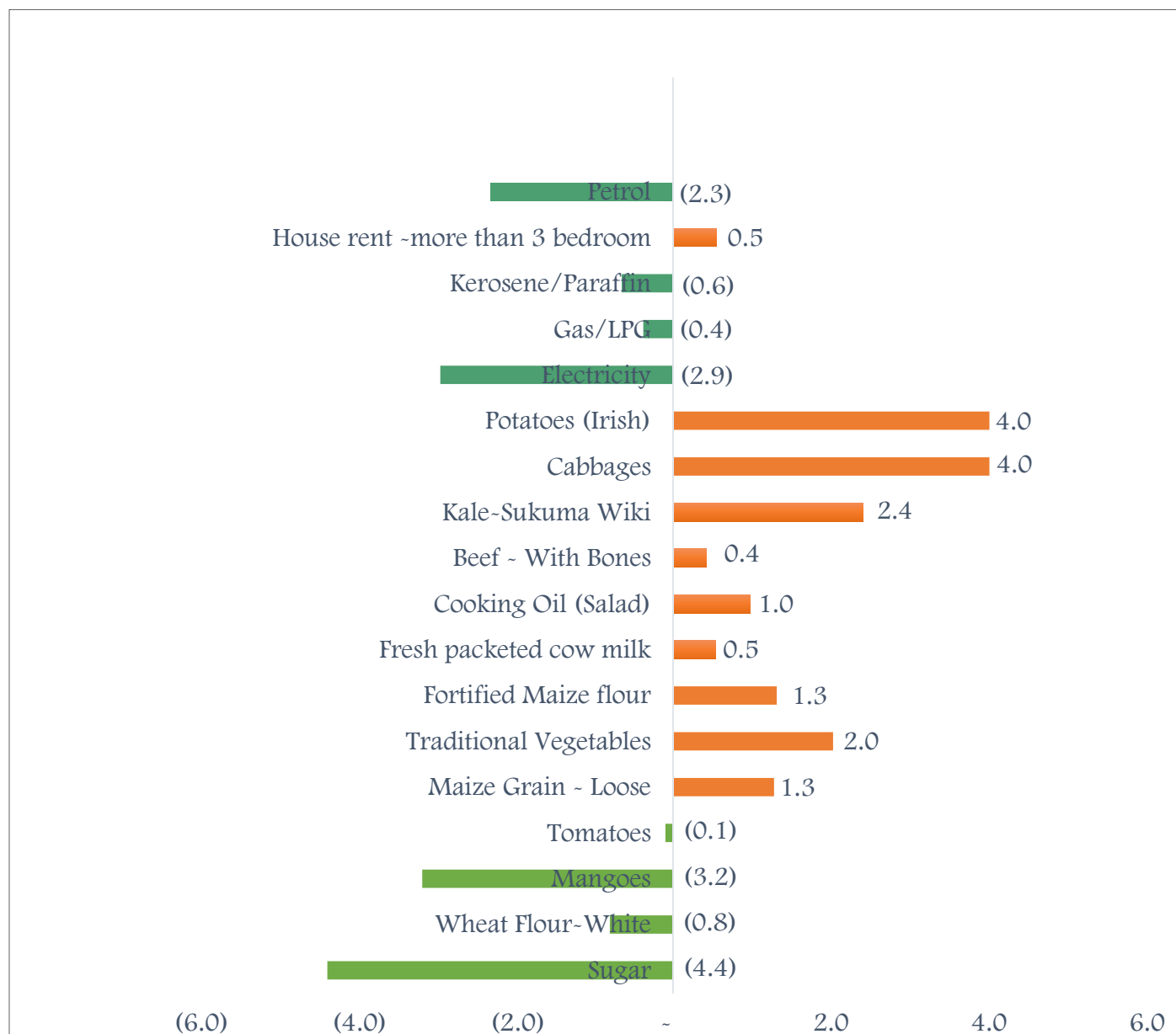
In contrast, price of Irish potatoes went up from KSh 98.25 to KSh 102.16 per kilogramme and that of a kilogramme of cabbage increased to KSh 74.33 from KSh 71.47 during the same period.

During the same period, the price of a litre of kerosene/paraffin declined from KSh 154.96 to KSh 153.96. Electricity costs decreased, with 200 kWh reducing from KSh 5,718.08 to KSh 5,564.96, and that of 50 kWh going down from KSh 1,304.29 to KSh 1,265.96. The prices of petrol and diesel eased, with that of petrol decreasing from KSh 183.59 to KSh 179.35 per litre, and diesel reducing from KSh 171.64 to KSh 167.72 per litre.

Table 3: National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Commodity Name	Quantity	Unit of Measure	Average Price February 2025	Average Price January 2026	Average Price February 2026	% Change over last month February 2026/ January 2026	% Change over last year February 2026/ February 2025
Sugar	1	Kg	166.45	174.17	166.56	-4.4	0.1
Wheat Flour-White	2	Kg	165.29	172.15	170.78	-0.8	3.3
Mangoes	1	Kg	120.26	149.09	144.37	-3.2	20.0
Tomatoes	1	Kg	79.88	87.98	87.90	-0.1	10.0
Maize Grain - Loose	1	Kg	62.68	71.28	72.19	1.3	15.2
Traditional Vegetables	1	Kg	107.82	118.73	121.14	2.0	12.4
Fortified Maize flour	2	Kg	160.33	173.51	175.79	1.3	9.6
Fresh packeted cow milk	500	Milliliter	56.79	56.50	56.80	0.5	0.0
Cooking Oil (Salad)	1	Litre	350.10	342.50	345.83	1.0	-1.2
Beef - With Bones	1	Kg	666.74	721.35	724.40	0.4	8.6
Kale-Sukuma Wiki	1	Kg	83.32	102.45	104.90	2.4	25.9
Cabbages	1	Kg	51.83	71.47	74.33	4.0	43.4
Potatoes (Irish)	1	Kg	86.37	98.25	102.16	4.0	18.3
Electricity	50	kWh	1,255.06	1,304.29	1,265.96	-2.9	0.9
Electricity	200	kWh	5,634.92	5,718.08	5,564.78	-2.7	-1.2
Gas/LPG	13	Kg	3,139.65	3,146.51	3,134.75	-0.4	-0.2
Kerosene/Paraffin	1	Litre	152.18	154.96	153.96	-0.6	1.2
House rent -more than 3 bedroom	1	Per Month	43,636.02	43,880.72	44,120.86	0.5	1.1
Petrol	1	Litre	177.25	183.59	179.35	-2.3	1.2
Diesel	1	Litre	167.84	171.64	167.72	-2.3	-0.1

Figure 5: Percentage Change Over Last Month, January 2026 – February 2026



Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Core inflation is a measure of inflation that is compiled from non-volatile commodities such as manufactured food items, health services, education services, and ICT. Core inflation decreased to 2.1 per cent in February 2026, as presented in Table 4. The core index increased from 130.60 in January 2026 to 130.72 in February 2026. Non-core inflation was 10.1 per cent during the same period.

Table 4: Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Period	Core Index	Core Inflation	Non-Core Index	Non-Core Inflation
Feb-25	128.01	1.9	204.01	7.7
Mar-25	128.35	2.2	205.55	7.4
Apr-25	128.48	2.5	206.86	8.4
May-25	128.97	2.8	209.35	6.0
Jun-25	129.47	3.0	211.24	6.2
Jul-25	129.59	3.1	211.69	7.2
Aug-25	129.57	3.0	213.85	9.2
Sep-25	129.52	2.9	215.78	9.6
Oct-25	129.56	2.7	216.87	9.9
Nov-25	129.66	2.3	217.54	10.1
Dec-25	130.09	2.0	220.84	11.2
Jan-26	130.60	2.2	223.74	10.3
Feb-26	130.72	2.1	224.68	10.1

Contribution of Core and Non-Core to the Overall Inflation

Contribution of core and non-core inflation to the overall inflation is presented in Table 5. Core inflation contributed 2.51 points, while non-core inflation contributed 1.73 points to the overall inflation in February 2026. Food and non-alcoholic beverages contributed to 2.15 points to the overall inflation during the same period.

Table 5: Core and Non-Core Contributions, February 2026

Broad Categories	Core	Non Core	Total
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	0.75	1.41	2.15
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	0.10	~	0.10
Clothing and Footwear	0.17	~	0.17
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	0.10	0.17	0.27
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household	0.18	~	0.18
Health	0.16	~	0.16
Transport	0.25	0.16	0.50
Information and Communication	0.06	~	0.06
Recreation, Sport and Culture	0.09	~	0.09
Education Services	0.18	~	0.18
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	0.22	~	0.22
Insurance and Financial Services	0.04	~	0.04
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods	0.19	~	0.19
Total	2.51	1.73	4.33



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